Inspection Report

Porter County Parks and Recreation

155 Indiana Ave #304
Valparaiso, IN 46383

Customer ID: **326051**
Certificate: **32-C-0257**
Site: 002
Porter County Parks and Recreation

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION
Date: 06-OCT-2026

3.53(a)(1)

Primary enclosures.

The facility's outdoor primary enclosure for three rabbits did not effectively contain all of the animals.

Employees reported that around mid-May, a 3-4 month old dwarf rabbit ("Trixie") escaped her outdoor enclosure. Due to her small size, speed, and agility, catching Trixie took a full day and a team of six employees. Employees reported that after catching her, they subsequently returned her to the outdoor enclosure unharmed. The facility added a high-gauge mesh fencing to the enclosure to prevent future escapes.

Employees did not realize a small gap remained. Around June 6, Trixie escaped a second time and took residence under an unused chicken shelter adjacent to her enclosure. Employees reported that this time, there were only two part-time employees available to attempt to catch Trixie, and efforts were ineffective. Employees set several traps around the area, checked on her several times daily and provided food and water. Approximately 6 days later, Trixie was successfully trapped and relocated to an indoor enclosure. Trixie appeared in good health.

The primary enclosure was not maintained in an appropriate condition to effectively contain this rabbit, leading to two escapes. Escapes can be detrimental to animals' health and well-being.

The facility mended the gap in the enclosure and Trixie is still housed indoors. Continue to correct from this day forward by ensuring primary enclosures are maintained in good repair to protect the rabbits from injury, to contain them, and to keep predators out.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with facility representatives.

You may appeal all or part of any inspection report by submitting a written statement contesting the findings—along with any supporting documentation—to the Deputy Administrator. Appeals of routine, focused, or attempted inspections must be received within 21 days of report issuance as shown by the signature line of this report.

Appeals may be sent by email to AnimalCare@usda.gov.

Prepared By: ALEXANDRA FRIEDMAN
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title:
Date: 07-OCT-2026

Received by Title: Facility Representative
Date: 07-OCT-2026

Inspection Report

Appeals sent by mail should be addressed to:
Deputy Administrator
APHIS Animal Care (AC)
U.S. Department of Agriculture
2150 Centre Avenue, Building B
Mailstop #3W11
Fort Collins, CO 80526-8117

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United States Department of Agriculture
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
326051	32-C-0257	002	Porter County Parks and Recreation	06-OCT-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000006	*Capra hircus*	DOMESTIC GOAT
000002	*Ovis aries aries*	SHEEP INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS
000003	*Oryctolagus cuniculus*	DOMESTIC RABBIT / EUROPEAN RABBIT
000006	*Gallus gallus domesticus*	DOMESTIC CHICKEN (INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS / TURKIN / COCK / HEN / ROOSTER)
000003	*Anas platyrhynchos domesticus*	DOMESTIC DUCK INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS
000020	**Total**	